Adaptive HACT: Information Limits and Safe Adaptation of Verification Evidence

Da Xu and Fei Wang

Abstract—Adaptive verification evidence poses two questions: which completion statistics identify an efficient representation, and how may that representation change without weakening acceptance? Adaptive HACT separates a protected semantic registry from generation-fenced certificate trees and prices packets touched by joint completion sets. We prove that exact singleton and pairwise probabilities can leave globally optimal trees unidentified for every fanout at least three and every affine positive-slot packet price, with sharp minimax regret. A complete-epoch construction extends the limitation to fixed-eight batching in a two-layout class even when all bivariate completion-rank laws agree. Conversely, exchangeable complete batches admit an exact global tree/permutation optimizer using $O(bn^2)$ arithmetic operations. This specialization of cardinality-based tree optimization supplies a no-learning baseline. A local publication invariant preserves acceptance through migration; a conditional paired-cost rule accounts for calibration, workload shift and installation. Independent enumeration checks the symmetric optimum in 74,245 tree comparisons. Retrospective scoring of 30 controlled dispatch shifts finds that this baseline beats frozen full-wave refinement on all 15 item-shuffled traces and loses on all 15 file-group traces. It also costs 21.26–62.13% more on original repeated-order holdouts. With byte observers disabled, the tree service takes 1.61–3.54 times the maintained-counter ledger's operation time. The results establish information limits, a tractable null regime and safe adaptation conditions; service and agent speedups remain unproven.

Index Terms—Verification evidence, software agents, completion hypergraphs, adaptive data structures, runtime assurance.

1 Introduction

Software agents navigate repositories, run checks and revise candidates over trajectories much longer than a single generated patch. Repository benchmarks and systems such as SWE-bench, SWE-agent and OpenHands make the interaction between generation and tooling observable [1], [2], [3]. Verification-first approaches additionally bind consequential actions to checkable evidence [4], [5]. These systems create an infrastructure question even when the checker and acceptance criteria are already fixed: how may an orchestrator reorganize accumulated evidence without changing what that evidence authorizes?

Operators may inspect incomplete coverage, locate failures, replay completion batches and request bounded diagnostic pages. An indexed ledger can already provide these services; a hierarchy must repay construction, maintenance and adaptation. Optimizing a prescribed packet format also requires justifying that format's consumer utility.

Adaptive HACT (Hyperedge-Aware Certificate Trees) separates a protected semantic registry from a replaceable certificate tree. Acceptance requires current trusted records for all declared checks; advisory layouts change only representation. A monotone generation fences publication tickets through migration, including a return to an earlier layout.

The representation objective depends on completion *sets*. If several checks finish before a refresh, an internal packet is emitted once whenever its coverage intersects that set. Pairwise co-activity is convenient for ordering leaves, but can omit the higher-order event that determines whether a larger subtree is touched. Our main theoretical result goes beyond showing different costs for one chosen subtree: it constructs identical pairwise observations with disjoint globally optimal trees for an entire family of packet prices and fanouts. A sharp minimax penalty quantifies what even exact pairwise information cannot recover.

The fixed-eight extension shows that this obstruction also affects a specified local refinement decision when every check completes exactly once; it does not promote the embedded layouts to global optima. Table 2 separates these claims from the established ingredients.

The obstruction disappears under a declared symmetry model. If a uniform completion permutation is divided into fixed batch sizes, expected packet cost depends only on coverage cardinality. A size-state dynamic program then optimizes all shapes and permutations exactly in $O(bn^2)$ arithmetic operations. This model-specific instance of established batch-update tree optimization [18] is a stronger null baseline than one compact topology: when the future law remains exchangeable conditional on training, learning cannot improve its expected cost.

The practical question remains empirical. A compiler that retains full waves may still offer little improvement over a compact balanced tree. A hierarchical service may also lose to a ledger with maintained counters. We test both possibilities without using an analytical separation as evidence of an execution speedup. The paper makes four contributions:

1) A conditional local invariant separating acceptance semantics from adaptive evidence layouts, including stable identities, conflicts and generation-fenced migration.

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2) A packet-refresh model and a parameter-general information lower bound with sharp deterministic and randomized pairwise-only regret, plus a fixed-batch candidate-class separation.
3) An exact global reference under exchangeable complete batches, contrasted with bounded full-wave refinement for structured observations; a conditional adoption rule uses paired-cost bounds, calibration uncertainty and installation amortization.
4) A reproducible evaluation distinguishing historical representation results, new upstream test executions and controlled service demand, with strong ledger controls and explicit resource failures.

Classical alphabetic optimization, clustering, caching and expert selection remain established ingredients. We make no priority claim for the general use of hyperedges or hierarchies. Our claim concerns their explicit composition under the stated verification contract and packet objective.

2 Model and Measurement Contract

Let $\mathcal{R} = (g_0, \dots, g_{n-1})$ be a nonempty registry of unique semantic check IDs. A candidate identity $e = (\mathrm{epoch}, \mathrm{snapshot}, \mathrm{checker}, \mathrm{environment}, \mathrm{registry})$ binds the source and protected acceptance inputs. The epoch increases even after a return to identical source bytes. Only a trusted runner can supply final PASS, FAIL or UNKNOWN records. Missing, stale, skipped, incompatible or timed-out evidence does not count as a pass.

A layout $L = (\pi, T)$ maps leaf positions through an exact permutation π of semantic indices. Each internal node's children partition its positional interval without overlap or omissions. Its semantic coverage is $G_L(v)$. Check execution order is independent of layout order. The acceptance predicate is, with $E_e(g_i)$ denoting the current matching trusted status,

$$A(e) = \prod_{g_i \in \mathcal{R}} \mathbf{1}\{E_e(g_i) = \mathsf{PASS}\}. \tag{1}$$

An observed failure permits rejection before the remaining checks execute, but supplies no evidence for the unexecuted remainder.

An internal node with d children emits a packet costing

$$c(d) = H + Sd, \qquad 2 \le d \le b = \lfloor (C - H)/S \rfloor. \tag{2}$$

The implementation uses $H = 512$, $S = 320$, $C = 3072$ bytes and $b = 8$. Mandatory fields exceeding their slots are rejected. The cap is per packet; registry manifests are separate control artifacts whose bytes must be charged.

Let $U_{e,a}$ contain the semantic indices whose final records arrive between two refreshes. The strict-epoch padded cost is

$$\ell_e(L) = W(L) + \sum_a \sum_{v \in \mathrm{int}(T)} c(d_v) \mathbf{1}\{G_L(v) \cap U_{e,a} \neq \varnothing\}, \tag{3}$$

where $W(L) = \sum_v c(d_v)$ constructs an initially unknown tree. We call $U_{e,a}$ a completion hyperedge. This model charges the full initial tree and every touched ancestor, rather than using independent activation probabilities. Persistent refresh models omit a cold build at each event; each actual installation is still cold and priced.

A layout switch from i to j additionally costs $M_{ij} = |\mathrm{manifest}(L_j)| + W(L_j)$ when layouts differ. This is the evaluated uncompressed installation protocol, not a universal network cost. A format using compression or deltas defines a different objective and needs its own measurements. Padded packets, compressed archives, answer traffic, serialized state, RAM and elapsed time remain separate units.

3 An Information Limit of Pairwise Summaries

Proposition 1 (Pairwise probabilities omit subtree-hit information)**.** *On three leaves, let P be uniform on $\varnothing, \{0,1\}, \{0,2\}, \{1,2\}$ and Q uniform on $\{0\}, \{1\}, \{2\}, \{0,1,2\}$. Both have singleton probabilities $1/2$, pairwise joint probabilities $1/4$ and Jaccard affinities $1/3$, but the triple is touched with probabilities $3/4$ and 1.*

This parity fact alone does not imply different global optima: another tree might dominate in both worlds. The following theorem rules that out under the affine packet objective.

Theorem 2 (Pairwise information has a sharp optimization penalty)**.** *Let $b \ge 3$ be an integer, $H \ge 0$, $S > 0$, and $\lambda \ge 0$. For $n = b + 1$ labeled leaves and internal arities $2, \dots, b$, define*

$$J_D(T; \lambda) = \lambda W(T) + \mathbb{E}_{U \sim D} \sum_{v \in \mathrm{int}(T)} c(d_v) \mathbf{1}\{G(v) \cap U \neq \varnothing\}.$$

There are distributions P, Q with identical singleton and pairwise probabilities but disjoint globally optimal tree sets, over every feasible shape and leaf permutation. With $W_2 = 2H + S(b+2)$,

$$J_P^* = (1+\lambda)W_2 - (H + 3S)/4, \tag{4}$$

$$J_Q^* = (1+\lambda)W_2 - (H + 2S)/4. \tag{5}$$

Any deterministic selector observing only those exact pairwise summaries has worst-case regret at least $S/4$. The sharp randomized minimax regret is

$$\frac{S(H+2S)}{4(H+3S)}. \tag{6}$$

Sibling orders are treated as equivalent.

Proof. Append $b-2$ anchor leaves, present in every event, to the two three-leaf parity laws of Proposition 1. Every singleton and pairwise probability agrees, including anchor/parity pairs. An anchor-containing node is always touched; a node containing only parity leaves is touched with probability at least $3/4$.

If I is the number of internal nodes, edge counting gives $W(T) = I(H + S) + Sb$, and the arity cap implies $I \ge 2$. At most two internal nodes contain only the three parity leaves. If there are two, both are binary; if there is one, its arity is at most three. Their total price is at most $2c(2)$. Thus for either law and $I \ge 3$,

$$J_D(T; \lambda) \ge (1+\lambda)W(T) - c(2)/2.$$

A tree with two internal nodes and a parity-pair child costs $(1+\lambda)W_2 - c(2)/4$ under either law. Every $I \ge 3$ lower bound exceeds that pair tree by at least

$$(1+\lambda)(H+S) - c(2)/4 = (3H + 2S)/4 + \lambda(H+S) > 0.$$

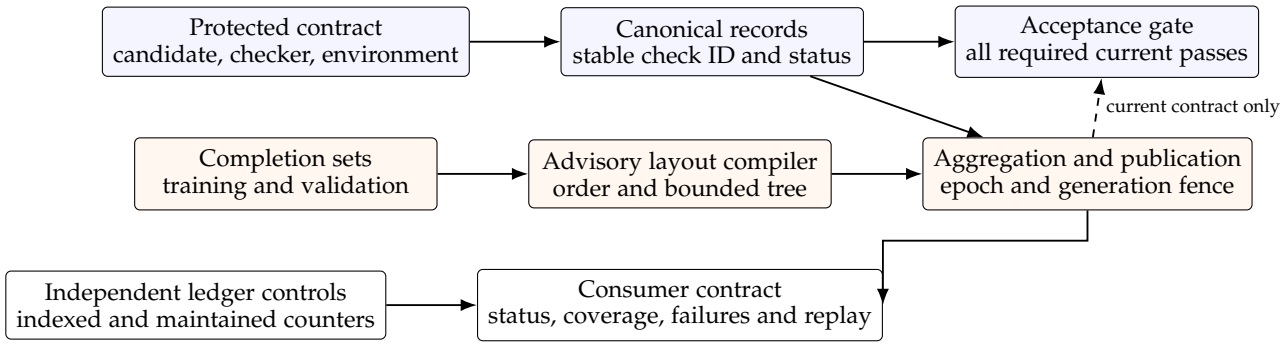


Fig. 1. Semantic authority, adaptive representation and the consumer contract. The compiler cannot modify the protected contract or canonical outcomes. Both ledger controls and the tree answer the same diagnostic requests. Diagram source was developed with OpenAI Codex (October 2026 session); it is rendered from the included TikZ source.

TABLE 1
Constructed witness at $H = 512, S = 320, b = 8$. Refresh optima are bold. Construction adds 4,224 bytes to either tree.

Only internal child	P	Q
Parity triple $\{0, 1, 2\}$	**3,856**	4,224
Any parity pair	3,936	**3,936**

Such trees are componentwise dominated. With $I = 2$, a child containing an anchor is also dominated by a parity pair. The remaining choices are a parity pair or the full parity triple. A pair is missed with probability $1/4$ under either law. The triple is missed with probability $1/4$ under P and zero under Q. Since $c(3) > c(2)$, P uniquely chooses the triple, whereas Q chooses any of its three pairs. This proves Equations (4)–(5), including construction.

A pairwise-only rule receives identical inputs in both worlds. All other tree classes are dominated, so a randomized rule need only choose the triple with probability q and a pair otherwise. Its two regrets are

$$r_P(q) = S(1 - q)/4, \qquad r_Q(q) = (H + 2S)q/4.$$

The best deterministic choice is a pair, giving worst-case regret $S/4$. Equating the two affine regrets gives $q^* = S/(H + 3S)$ and Equation (6). This mixture attains the lower bound. □

The result covers every affine positive-slot price and every fanout at least three; it is not specific to the artifact's selected byte constants. It concerns an interface exposing exact population pairwise summaries. It does not assert equivalence of finite-sample statistical experiments: joint fluctuations of empirical summary vectors can retain higher-order information. It neither bounds a method that retains full waves nor establishes the prevalence of such laws in software executions. The events describe persistent refresh; a partial event is not asserted to be a complete strict verification epoch.

At these prices the deterministic penalty is 80 bytes; randomized minimax regret is $1440/23 \simeq 62.609$ bytes, attained by choosing the triple with probability $5/23$. Integer byte counts are the implementation case; the theorem also allows real prices. Its zero-header boundary does not change the serializer's stricter positive-header validation.

An independently implemented exact rational reference checks 39 parameter cases, including zero headers, fractional construction and header-dominated prices. It imports no HACT objective or optimizer. The nine-leaf case visits 511 nonempty subset subproblems and 115,462 candidate partitions *across those subproblems*; it finds one P optimum and three Q optima. Twenty-three tests include independently listed four-leaf trees and deliberate formula corruption. These are analytical checks, not additional software workloads.

3.1 The separation also occurs in complete epochs

Persistent refresh is not the only affected regime. Complete epochs partition all obligations into disjoint nonempty waves.

Theorem 3 (Complete-epoch information separation)**.** *For any fanout $b \geq 6$, $S > 0$ and $16/11 < H/S < 28/17$, two laws on six checks partitioned into three nonempty waves have identical population singleton and pairwise completion statistics but disjoint unique global tree optima. Define*

$$\Delta_P = (28S - 17H)/8, \qquad \Delta_Q = (11H - 16S)/5.$$

The sharp deterministic pairwise-only regret is $\min(\Delta_P, \Delta_Q)$; the sharp randomized minimax regret is $\Delta_P\Delta_Q/(\Delta_P + \Delta_Q)$.

Proof sketch; full orbit certificate in the companion analysis. Let $G = \{0, 1, 2, 3\}$, $O = \{4, 5\}$. A block's type (g, o) counts its members from G, O. Let $A = (G, \{4\}, \{5\})$, and let B, C, D be uniform over partitions with block-type multisets respectively

$$B : \{(2, 1), (2, 0), (0, 1)\},$$
$$C : \{(2, 1), (1, 1), (1, 0)\},$$
$$D : \{(2, 0), (1, 1), (1, 1)\}.$$

Take $P = 7A/8 + B/8$, $Q = 9A/10 + C/20 + D/20$. Within-G same-wave probabilities are $11/12$, cross probabilities $1/32$, and the O pair probability zero in both laws. Uniformly permuting wave order aligns every window-specific first/second moment.

Contraction strictly improves every nonroot binary or ternary internal node throughout the stated price interval. With only six leaves, this reduces all potentially optimal shapes to a flat root or one internal child. Exact counting over the remaining coverage orbits leaves only flat and the

tree grouping G nondominated. Their cost differences are Δ_P and $-\Delta_Q$. Mixing these two actions and equating their regrets gives the stated minimax result. The companion analysis supplies the contraction inequalities and all orbit coefficients; an independent exact reference checks all 2,752 labeled unordered trees. □

At the implemented prices the two wrong-choice penalties are 32 and 102.4 bytes; randomized minimax regret is $512/21$ bytes. This constructed law has variable-width windows. The next result connects it to fixed-eight batching without claiming a global 24-leaf optimum.

3.2 Fixed-width batches retain a local information gap

The previous theorem allows variable window widths. The following lift connects the information limit to the evaluated eight-completion flush. Its conclusion concerns two fixed feasible layouts; it does not assert global optimality over all trees of the enlarged registry.

Lemma 4 (Uniform equal-width padding)**.** *Let a random partition of n original checks have q blocks of size at most w. Add $F = qw - n \geq 2$ distinct filler checks, uniformly allocating them to the block deficits. If p_{ij} is the original probability that i, j share a block, then the same-block probabilities are*

$$p_{if} = \frac{w - 1 - \sum_{j \neq i} p_{ij}}{F}, \tag{7}$$

$$p_{fg} = \frac{qw(w-1) - (2w-2)n + 2\sum_{i<j} p_{ij}}{F(F-1)} \quad (f \neq g). \tag{8}$$

Thus identical original pairwise probabilities imply identical pairwise probabilities on the padded registry.

Proof. If i lies in a block of size k, its block receives $w - k$ fillers, so a named filler joins it with probability $(w-k)/F$. Taking expectations and using $\mathbb{E}(k-1) = \sum_{j \neq i} p_{ij}$ gives (7). For distinct fillers the conditional probability is $\sum_{a=1}^{q}(w - k_a)(w - k_a - 1)/[F(F-1)]$. Expand the numerator and use $\sum_a k_a = n$ and $\mathbb{E}\sum_a k_a(k_a - 1) = 2\sum_{i<j} p_{ij}$ to obtain (8). Original pair memberships are unchanged. □

Proposition 5 (Fixed-eight candidate-class separation)**.** *For $b \geq 6$ and the price interval of Theorem 3, there are two laws on complete 24-check execution sequences with identical population bivariate completion-rank distributions, but opposite preferred choices in a two-layout candidate class under consecutive batches of eight. The two wrong-choice penalties remain Δ_P, Δ_Q; the class-relative sharp randomized minimax regret is $\Delta_P\Delta_Q/(\Delta_P + \Delta_Q)$.*

Proof. Apply Lemma 4 to the six-check laws with $q = 3, w = 8, F = 18$. Their largest original block has size four. Original–filler probabilities are $67/288$ for G and $55/144$ for O; filler–filler probability is $191/612$, in both worlds. Uniformly permute the three blocks and independently shuffle the eight members of each. For two distinct checks with same-block probability p, the probability of any specified pair of distinct completion ranks is $p/[qw(w-1)]$ if the ranks lie in one batch, and $(1-p)/[q(q-1)w^2]$ otherwise. Singleton ranks are uniform. Hence every bivariate rank distribution agrees, while grouping consecutive ranks by eight recovers the padded partition exactly.

Place the original six checks below one child of a common root and a fixed feasible filler-only tree below its other child. The two candidate layouts use respectively the flat six-leaf subtree and T_G from Theorem 3. The root and filler subtree contribute the same cost to both choices within each world, including construction. The original subtree's touched windows are unchanged. Subtracting the common terms preserves Δ_P and Δ_Q, and the same two-action minimax calculation applies. Common costs need not agree between worlds. □

At the implemented prices, the wrong-choice penalties are 32 and 102.4 bytes and the class-relative randomized penalty is $512/21$ bytes. The exact reference enumerates all 740 and 2,540 positive-mass padded partitions in the smaller $w = 4, F = 6$ instance, independently checks the pairwise formulas, and checks actual batching and packet costs on 600 complete 24-check sequences. Thirty tests cover these identities and deliberate corruptions. Enumeration and representative sequence conformance support the implementation; the padding and cancellation arguments establish the general claim. Neither this construction nor its rank equivalence implies that empirical pairwise-summary vectors have identical joint laws, or that the two embedded layouts are globally optimal on 24 checks.

4 Semantics Through Adaptation

A result token carries the candidate epoch, stable ID g_i and a binding to the identified registry, source, checker and environment. It does not use a display position as identity. A layout-specific kernel maps each stable ID to its current position. Migration revokes publication tickets, increments a monotone generation and reconstructs from canonical records. Reusing an ordinal cache entry under another permutation is disallowed.

Identical duplicate evidence is idempotent. Conflicting final records in an epoch revoke authorization: a recorded failure remains a failure, and other conflicts become unknown. A new epoch is required to resolve them. Publication tickets additionally bind the layout hash and generation. Returning to an earlier tree therefore cannot revive its earlier ticket.

Theorem 6 (Layout-independent local publication)**.** *Assume a complete approved registry and dependency identities, a trusted checker executing immutable identified inputs, collision-resistant bindings and atomic local epoch/generation checks. For any valid sequence of layouts, advisory learning outputs and delivered evidence order, authorization implies $A(e) = 1$. Two valid layouts reconstructed from the same canonical record set have identical root pass/fail/unknown counts.*

Proof. A canonical pass requires a current token bound to the same semantic ID and immutable identities. A permutation is a bijection, so reconstruction moves each record exactly once without changing its status. Exact child partitions preserve coverage and counts by induction from leaves to root. Authorization requires root counts $(n, 0, 0)$ together with matching current registry, epoch, layout and generation. Old tickets fail those checks; conflicts prevent a pass. Advisory layout selection cannot change any canonical outcome or approved obligation. □

The raw aggregation kernel is an internal component; conflict persistence and tickets are implemented by the guard. The claim is local and conditional. A compromised checker, incomplete suite or omitted dependency invalidates a broader correctness claim. The mechanism supplies neither attestation nor an OS sandbox. An external merge service must separately and atomically bind the verified candidate to its actual integration head.

The implementation hashes protected input *sets*, detecting additions, changes and deletions of tests or configuration. Source manifests are checked before and after snapshotting and verification. Candidate snapshots and detailed evidence are stored outside the candidate's write scope; only a bounded result card returns to the worker. The scientific artifact includes stale-token, conflict, migration, coverage and source-mutation regressions. A passing regression suite is implementation evidence, not evidence that the declared predicates cover all program behavior.

5 Bounded Full-Wave Compilation

5.1 Exact fitting at a fixed order

For a fixed order π, training epochs define interval weights

$$r_\pi(i,j) = 1 + \frac{1}{m}\sum_{e=1}^{m}\sum_{a}\mathbf{1}\{U_{e,a} \cap G_L(i,j) \neq \varnothing\}. \quad (9)$$

The one charges construction per strict epoch. In a persistent refresh study that term is omitted explicitly. Let $D(i,j)$ be the best subtree cost and $F_k(i,j)$ the best ordered k-component forest. Infeasible states are infinite:

$$\begin{aligned} D(i,i) &= 0, \qquad F_1(i,j) = D(i,j), \\ F_k(i,j) &= \min_{i+k-2\le u<j}\{F_{k-1}(i,u) + D(u+1,j)\}, \\ D(i,j) &= \min_{2\le k\le \min(b,j-i+1)}\{r_\pi(i,j)c(k) + F_k(i,j)\}. \end{aligned} \quad (10)$$

The recurrence enumerates every root arity and contiguous partition. Induction on interval length proves exactness for the supplied nonnegative weights, conditional on order. It uses $O(bn^3)$ time and $O(bn^2)$ space. This specializes classical alphabetic-tree optimization [6]; it is not a global permutation optimizer or an optimum for compressed logs.

5.2 A bounded restricted optimizer

The historical practical method fits Jaccard affinities, obtains an average-linkage order and groups consecutive leaves into compact blocks of at most eight. Full-wave validation retains either the incumbent or the learned compact layout. The new optional method refines *maximal existing subtrees* containing at most s leaves. Each selected subtree is disjoint from the others. It keeps the order and that subtree's leaf interval, solves Equation (10) on projected training waves, and accepts a replacement only if the complete integer training objective strictly decreases. All larger ancestors remain unchanged; ties retain the incumbent subtree.

Proposition 7 (Restricted exactness and bounded refinement)**.** *For a fixed order and fixed disjoint refinement intervals, independent exact fitting minimizes training cost over trees obtained by replacing only those subtrees. Retaining the incumbent on ties gives nonincreasing integer training cost. For intervals of sizes $m_i \le s$, the DP work is at most $O(bns^2)$ with $O(bs^2)$ peak DP storage, apart from input projection, cost computation and ordering.*

Proof. All ancestor contributions depend only on the unchanged coverage and arity. The mutable objective is the sum of independent interval objectives, so minimizing each minimizes the restricted sum. The incumbent is feasible in every subproblem. Since $\sum_i m_i \le n$, $\sum_i m_i^3 \le s^2\sum_i m_i \le ns^2$. Sequential solution gives the stated storage bound. Integer rescoring rejects a numerically nonimproving DP replacement. □

The implementation uses float64 inside the existing recurrence; exactness is to numerical precision. Independent integer rescoring establishes monotonicity, not exact rational optimality for every large instance. Independent literal-tree enumeration checks tiny cases. Every leaf remains present exactly once and all packet arities remain feasible.

The primary frozen cap is $s = 32$; 64 is a secondary sensitivity. A nominal cap of 32 often refines only eight-leaf subtrees of a compact8 tree, because its next ancestors have 64 leaves. Reporting the actual largest subproblem prevents describing a locality restriction as global optimization. Dense pairwise ordering still has quadratic storage and approximately $O(n^2 \log n)$ heap work. It can dominate bounded refinement and is admitted separately under the resource budget.

5.3 An exact global baseline under completion symmetry

The information lower bound is a worst-case statement. A structured null regime admits a global optimum without learning co-activity. Fix nonempty batch sizes $w_1, \dots, w_q$ summing to n. Complete a uniformly random permutation of the registry and partition it into those consecutive batches. For any semantic coverage G of size s, the expected number of touched waves is

$$r_n(s) - 1 = \sum_{a=1}^{q}\left(1 - \frac{\binom{n-s}{w_a}}{\binom{n}{w_a}}\right), \quad (11)$$

where a binomial coefficient with upper argument smaller than its lower argument is zero. The one in $r_n(s)$ charges the cold build. No independence among checks or waves is assumed. The formula also follows from exchangeability conditional on the declared ordered batch sizes.

Let $D(s)$ minimize expected subtree cost for s leaves, using the *full-registry* weights $r_n(s)$. Let $F_d(s)$ minimize the sum of d nonempty child-subtree costs, with infeasible states infinite:

$$\begin{aligned} D(1) &= 0, \qquad F_1(s) = D(s), \\ F_d(s) &= \min_{1\le t\le s-d+1}\{D(t) + F_{d-1}(s-t)\}, \\ D(s) &= \min_{2\le d\le \min(b,s)}\{r_n(s)c(d) + F_d(s)\}. \end{aligned} \quad (12)$$

Theorem 8 (Global optimality under exchangeability)**.** *For the declared exchangeable completion law, Equation* (12) *minimizes the expected strict-epoch padded cost over every feasible tree shape and leaf permutation. After computing the weights, it uses $O(bn^2)$ arithmetic operations and $O(bn)$ states. With integer packet prices*

it can be evaluated exactly using a common denominator and integer numerators; arithmetic bit complexity is additional.

Proof. Any batch is a uniform w_a-subset of the full registry. Its probability of missing G is the binomial ratio in (11). Linearity of expectation gives each internal node the contribution $r_n(s)c(d)$, depending only on its coverage size and arity. Conditioning on a root's arity and nonempty child sizes leaves the sum of independent optimization subproblems; probabilistic independence is unnecessary. Induction on s proves the forest and tree recurrences enumerate all possible shapes. Relabeling leaves changes no expected contribution, so canonical depth-first labels attain the unrestricted permutation optimum. Every forest transition scans at most s splits for each (d, s), giving $O(bn^2)$ work and $O(bn)$ stored costs/splits. Multiplying all rational weights by their common denominator preserves every comparison and tie. □

Consequently, if a future epoch retains this exchangeable law conditional on the training data and selected layout, no training-dependent selection improves its expected padded cost below $D(n)$. Condition on that selection: each fixed tree costs at least $D(n)$, then average over training. Independent training and future epochs suffice; unconditional symmetry alone does not exclude training information that predicts the future completion pattern. This gives a concrete null baseline against which to test learning. Graham, Li and Yao already optimize batch-update key trees using cardinality states under independent Bernoulli replacements [18]. Our fixed-size, without-replacement law, affine capped packet prices and per-epoch cold charge specify a different instance; the size-state principle is established. Neither a shuffled dispatch queue nor a good fit to one trace establishes exchangeable completion times. Violating the model removes the global-optimality guarantee, so we also score this baseline on the frozen structured traces and retain its losses. The objective excludes query service, compilation seconds and installation manifests; those remain separate lifecycle ledgers. The model-derived layout is an optional advisory candidate and does not change the acceptance registry or runtime policy.

5.4 Validation and adoption

Training fixes a finite catalogue containing the incumbent first. Validation observes complete waves and selects the minimum padded cost, retaining the incumbent on ties. The historical method remains unchanged; the refined catalogue is optional.

Empirical validation alone gives no deployment guarantee. The following rule uses independent calibration and an explicit shift allowance. Repeated suite runs do not establish those sampling assumptions.

5.5 Conditional adoption with lifecycle costs

Selecting the smallest observed cost does not establish a net deployment benefit. The following rule makes the additional assumptions explicit. It specializes standard bounded-loss calibration and multiple-comparison control [7], [17]; it introduces no new concentration inequality. Its HACT-specific step is to bound *paired* differences after cancelling packets with the same semantic coverage.

Fix an incumbent L_0 and $K \geq 1$ training-fitted candidates L_j before calibration. All layouts use the same registry and packet contract. An epoch partitions the n checks into exactly q nonempty waves of at most w checks, with $q \leq n \leq qw$. Let $h_e(G)$ count the waves that intersect semantic coverage G. Aggregate the internal packet prices by coverage and subtract the candidate's coefficients from the incumbent's:

$$a_{jG} = \sum_{v:G_{L_0}(v)=G} c(d_v) - \sum_{v:G_{L_j}(v)=G} c(d_v).$$

Coefficients may have either sign. Shared packets cancel, regardless of their display positions. The strict-epoch saving is exactly

$$\begin{aligned} d_j(e) &= \ell_e(L_0) - \ell_e(L_j) \\ &= a_{j0} + \sum_G a_{jG} h_e(G), \quad a_{j0} = \sum_G a_{jG}. \end{aligned} \tag{13}$$

For $s = |G|$, the support implies

$$l_G = \max\{\lceil s/w \rceil, q - (n - s)\} \leq h_e(G) \leq u_G = \min(s, q). \tag{14}$$

The second lower bound follows because every untouched nonempty wave requires a distinct check outside G. In particular $h_e(\mathcal{R}) = q$. Define

$$\begin{aligned} A_j &= a_{j0} + \sum_{a_{jG}>0} a_{jG} l_G + \sum_{a_{jG}<0} a_{jG} u_G, \\ B_j &= a_{j0} + \sum_{a_{jG}>0} a_{jG} u_G + \sum_{a_{jG}<0} a_{jG} l_G. \end{aligned}$$

Set $R_j = B_j - A_j$. Thus $d_j(e) \in [A_j, B_j]$ on the entire declared support, rather than merely the observed epochs. Bounds for different coverages need not be jointly attainable, so this envelope is conservative.

Pairwise insufficiency does not require retaining every raw wave forever. Once a catalogue is frozen, exact paired scoring needs only the accumulated sum of each $d_j(e)$ and the number of epochs. More generally, the following standard linear-identification argument characterizes population scoring interfaces, and distinguishes exact score recovery from argmin recovery.

Proposition 9 (Exact population score identification)**.** *On the finite epoch support Ω, let an interface expose only $\mathbb{E}_P\phi_1, \ldots, \mathbb{E}_P\phi_p$ for all probability laws P. It determines every expected paired score $\mathbb{E}_P d_j$, for every P, if and only if each function d_j belongs to $\operatorname{span}\{1, \phi_1, \ldots, \phi_p\}$ on Ω. The smallest number of scalar expectation features for exact scoring is the dimension of the span of the d_j modulo constant functions.*

Proof. Span membership supplies an affine recovery formula. Conversely, if d_j is outside the span, finite-dimensional orthogonality supplies a signed vector z annihilating 1 and every ϕ_i but not d_j. Its positive and negative parts have the same nonzero mass. Normalizing them yields laws P, Q with equal exposed summaries but different expected paired scores. The dimension statement follows by taking a basis modulo constants and applying the same argument to any lower-dimensional feature span. This concerns exact scoring; different scores alone do not imply different minimizing layouts, which requires the earlier separations. □

The implementation accumulates exact integer paired sums in one pass with $O(K)$ score counters, in addition to the frozen coverage coefficients and one epoch's masks. It retains no per-epoch loss rows on this path. Auditable source/checker records and any required raw provenance remain separate; score sufficiency grants no permission to discard acceptance evidence.

Theorem 10 (Conditional expected lifecycle benefit)**.** *Condition on training and the frozen catalogue, support, $0 < \delta < 1$, TV radius $0 \le \rho \le 1$, horizon $h \ge 1$ and nonnegative installation costs I_j, all specified before calibration. Suppose the $m \ge 1$ calibration epochs are IID from P and independent of fitting. Let $\bar{d}_j$ be their paired mean, and define*

$$t_j = R_j\sqrt{\frac{\log(K/\delta)}{2m}},$$
$$g_j = \max\{A_j, \bar{d}_j - t_j - \rho R_j\} - I_j/h. \tag{15}$$

With probability at least $1-\delta$ over calibration, simultaneously for all candidates and every future law Q on the same support with $\mathrm{TV}(P,Q) \le \rho$,

$$h\,\mathbb{E}_Q d_j - I_j \ge h g_j.$$

Adopting only a candidate with $g_j > 0$, otherwise retaining L_0, therefore certifies a conditional positive expected padded-byte benefit. This does not certify realized savings, elapsed time, or task acceptance.

Proof. For each fixed candidate the one-sided Hoeffding inequality gives $\Pr\{\mathbb{E}_P d_j < \bar{d}_j - t_j\} \le \delta/K$ when $R_j > 0$. When $R_j = 0$ the cost difference is constant and the conclusion holds deterministically. A union bound makes these inequalities simultaneous; candidate differences within an epoch need not be independent.

Use the convention $\mathrm{TV}(P,Q) = \sup_E |P(E) - Q(E)|$. For $R_j > 0$, normalize $(d_j - A_j)/R_j$ to $[0,1]$ and integrate its superlevel-set probabilities. It follows that $|\mathbb{E}_Q d_j - \mathbb{E}_P d_j| \le \rho R_j$, uniformly over the TV ball. For $R_j = 0$ the difference is zero. Since Q remains on the same support, also $\mathbb{E}_Q d_j \ge A_j$. Combining the bounds and subtracting I_j/h proves the claim. The simultaneous event permits selection of any qualifying candidate after calibration. □

The rule conditions on a *justified* sampling design and shift radius; neither is learned or verified from repeated observations by this theorem. If deployment can leave the declared support, the guarantee does not apply. Reusing calibration to refit layouts, choose the radius, or repeatedly deploy new catalogues needs additional error accounting. The implementation binds all plan parameters to a digest and requires external sampling/freeze provenance; an assertion string alone is not evidence of independence or chronology. Missing provenance or radius returns UNKNOWN and retains the incumbent. Installation costs are bytes in the declared protocol; compilation seconds and consumer utility remain separate admission tests. An installation operation already charged inside the first epoch must not also appear in I_j; the cost ledger must assign each operation once.

Compilation time, selection time and installation bytes are separately charged. A representation saving g bytes per later epoch repays a one-time byte installation I only after $hg > I$. Converting compilation seconds into that inequality requires a declared measured unit conversion. No token or agent-speed claim follows from padded-byte savings.

TABLE 2
Established ingredients and the contribution claimed here.

Established ingredient	Claim under the HACT contract
Alphabetic and batch-update tree DP	Exact fixed-order reference and global size-state optimum under declared exchangeability; both specialize established DP principles.
Pairwise clustering and hypergraphs	Explicit indistinguishable laws with disjoint global optima and sharp regret; fixed-batch local extension.
Epochs, identities and fencing	Conditional composition preserving the approved all-check acceptance predicate during representation migration.
Subtree optimization and validation	Bounded full-wave refinement; conditional paired-cost adoption under externally justified sampling and shift assumptions.
Ledgers, counters and common codecs	Controlled comparison separating representation gains from service costs, including losses.

6 Evaluation Protocol

The evaluation asks four questions:

1) Can the information limit and semantic invariant be checked independently?
2) Does bounded full-wave refinement improve over compact baselines?
3) Does a tree repay its full service costs against strong ledgers?
4) Which observed workload and resource boundaries limit adoption?

6.1 Evidence cohorts and frozen decisions

The historical artifact contains 27 synthetic train/validation/held-out cells and twelve archived candidate traces from three projects. The new compiler study reuses those frozen observations, retaining their original provenance. It does not count a new encoding as a new checker run.

The public cohort is a declared convenience sample: Click 8.2.1, Jinja 3.1.6, Packaging 25.0, Pluggy 1.6.0, attrs 25.3.0 and ExceptionGroup 1.3.0. Each tag is resolved to a commit, all tracked source files are hash-bound, and imported module origins are checked against the clean checkout. Five fresh process runs of the unchanged upstream suite are assigned in advance: runs 0–1 training, 2 validation, 3–4 held out. All final report phases and their actual arrival order are recorded. At most eight successive final completions form a refresh wave, matching the historical protocol. These are new test executions, not independent source changes, natural-bug repairs or agent episodes.

The registry is a canonical sorted ID set; actual collection, scheduling and completion orders are preserved separately. An instrumentation correction for collection-order variation is recorded before layout-cost analysis, with raw inputs retained. Skips, xfails and xpasses remain UNKNOWN. Ordinary failures remain in the data; environmental failures are disclosed and are not called upstream defects. Exclusions and resource admission decisions remain explicit.

The method and source receipts are frozen before held-out cost files are opened. The six requested projects, with five admitted to optimization, are the case-level units; individual checks, cached requests, process repeats and layout replays do not enlarge that sample. We report per-project measurements and avoid population-level superiority tests on this convenience cohort.

6.2 Controls, estimands and uncertainty

The primary compiler endpoint is strict-epoch padded bytes, including construction, refined selection versus historical compact selection. Original and pairwise orders are also compared before and after refinement at the *same order*. That control separates topology from ordering, but does not identify higher-order information as the cause of a gain. The exact parity construction checks that the method can use full waves when pairwise affinities agree; it is an analytical conformance case.

The service endpoint is the sum of measured local service operations over one complete retained trajectory: construction, every eight-completion ingest, query aggregation, encoding and decoding. Common input snapshot preparation and the independent oracle are outside both arms' timers. Checker execution is reported separately. Initial, intermediate and final snapshots each receive status, failure, unfinished, coverage and replay queries, each cold and repeated warm. This consumer sequence is fixed independently of layouts; it is a controlled integration workload, not observed production demand.

Controls include the original indexed ledger and a stronger ledger maintaining status counters for fixed semantic groups. Both tree and ledger independently query their maintained state. A third computation answers directly from raw records. Every answer, missing-obligation set and epoch must match; a mismatch halts performance promotion. All arms use identical bounded pages and deterministic DEFLATE encoding. Equal answers therefore imply equal answer bytes by composition, before any performance experiment. Serialized state and logical update bytes are separate from wire traffic and resident memory.

Three repeated whole-trajectory executions use seeded randomized arm order. Repeated timings describe this host and retained workload; they are not additional project replications. We report paired per-case summaries, retain unfavorable cases and avoid significance claims based on correlated query rows. Per-arm timeouts remain UNKNOWN rather than becoming successful zero-cost observations.

6.3 Review-motivated follow-up protocols

Two separately frozen follow-ups address weaknesses found in the original study. Both retain the original layouts and all unfavorable observations. First, each of the five admitted release suites executes under three fixed seeds crossed with two dispatch policies: shuffling test-file groups while preserving within-file order (primary), and shuffling individual items (secondary). These are actual complete pytest processes, not permutations of recorded outcomes. Registry equality, scheduled versus actual completion order, imported source origins and pre/post source hashes are checked. Fixed-eight waves from each completed execution are priced by an independent literal-tree evaluator. No layout is refitted, and a registry, timeout or provenance failure makes a case VOID or UNKNOWN. The method retains both the original compact and historical selected comparators.

Second, byte-count instrumentation in the original service serializes maintained state and records inside the timers. A new eight-arm campaign crosses all four services with original and observer-disabled implementations on the same ten admitted trajectories, with three seeded randomized-order repeats. Observer-disabled subclasses remove serialization used solely to measure byte counters; functional record copies, validation, evidence digests, kernel refresh and packet serialization, caches and answer-codec work remain. The old observations are not retroactively corrected. New semantic/wire oracle checks precede interpretation of timings. Full duplicate-aware package inventories and source/input hashes are frozen for both follow-ups.

OpenAI Codex supported implementation, proof checking, experiment orchestration and analysis; checks by separate AI agents are automated checks, not human peer review. Numerical tables and plots derive from retained JSON observations through the supplied Python scripts. The v11 figure code was assisted by Codex; the v12 analysis and revision also used Codex. Exact model-version identifiers were not captured in the experiment manifests. The raw observations, code and protocols permit verification without an AI service. No language model participates in the measured service operations.

7 Results and Applicability

7.1 Theory and semantic conformance

The independent rational reference verifies 39 parameter cases for Theorem 2. Independently listed literal trees, partition-count checks and formula-tampering tests reduce shared-code risk. The mathematical proof covers arbitrary admissible fanout and prices; finite enumeration checks its implementation and boundary examples, rather than substituting for the proof. Semantic regression tests cover stale tickets, conflicts, permutations and epoch/generation transitions.

7.2 Historical representation results and new ablation

Frozen clustered synthetic workloads yield held-out padded-byte savings of 23.43%, 10.75% and 5.56% at 128, 512 and 1,024 checks relative to the original balanced baseline. Independent/global controls show essentially no systematic benefit. Re-encoding the twelve archived candidates changes compressed hierarchical streams by 4.36–41.84%; these are within-format results and do not establish service superiority.

The new bounded-refinement experiment is more restrictive than a global optimizer. At cap 32, all 27 historical cells tie the validation-selected compact catalogue. At cap 64, 26 tie and one saves 0.00762% on held-out padded bytes. The isolated sensitivity gain is not a practical breakthrough or a confirmatory higher-order effect. Independent dictionary-tree reconstruction verifies the reported objectives without calling the producer's cost helper. The archived direct-wave heuristic also showed no gain. These results favor retaining a compact incumbent unless independent evidence pays for a more expensive compiler.

TABLE 3
New complete suites. Counts per held-out run; five runs per project. P/F/U are PASS/FAIL/UNKNOWN.

Project	Checks	P	F	U
Click	761	739	0	22
Jinja	909	909	0	0
Packaging	26,948	26,948	0	0
Pluggy	124	124	0	0
attrs	1,432	1,391	33	8
ExceptionGroup	102	91	0	11

TABLE 4
Held-out padded-byte reduction (%) relative to the historical compact catalogue. Construction is included. UNKNOWN is not a tie.

Project	Cap32 primary	Cap64 secondary
Click	1.493	17.219
Jinja	0.177	15.996
Packaging	UNKNOWN	
Pluggy	0.000	18.695
attrs	0.000	0.000
ExceptionGroup	0.000	18.690

7.3 New public-software executions

Thirty fresh process runs on six upstream projects record 151,380 check executions. Table 3 reports one held-out run per project; the second has the same counts. These counts are execution observations, not independent projects. Only five projects (25 runs, 16,640 check executions) are admitted to the compiler comparison. All five have identical completion orders and ordered wave partitions across runs 0–4. Thus the held-out costs measure repetition of observed completion patterns, not prediction of new patterns. attrs' 33 failures concern this environment (including mypy compatibility) and are retained without calling them upstream bugs. Skips, xfails and xpasses remain unknown.

Raw collection order varied in Packaging. Before any layout-cost analysis, a dated correction created separate canonical-registry copies, retaining the raw records and every scheduled/completed ID unchanged. Jinja's missing Trio test dependency was repaired before its five retained runs; the original failed attempt is preserved. Source files remain hash-verified. The original environment identifier binds Python/platform, not all dependencies. A post-hoc inventory records the repair and duplicate package metadata; it cannot retroactively establish a complete contemporaneous environment identity. Each representation comparison still uses the same persisted input trace.

7.4 Held-out topology costs

Table 4 compares frozen refined selections to historical compact selection. The primary cap32 method improves two of five admitted project cases and ties three. The cap64 results were designated secondary before collection; they do not replace the primary endpoint. Both methods are fitted on runs 0–1, selected on run 2 and scored on runs 3–4. All selected layouts were hash-frozen before those held-out costs were opened.

The positive secondary reductions range from 16.00% to 18.69%; attrs retains its incumbent. The gain is a measured topology-refinement effect at the stated order, not a causal demonstration that higher-order information alone explains it. Figure 2 separates this representation endpoint from service time.

TABLE 5
Local service operation time (ms), mean of two per-case medians over three whole-trajectory timing repeats. Builds, all ingests, queries and codec work are included. Layout fitting is reported separately. No network or agent inference occurs.

Project	Indexed	Counters	HACT32
Click	392.1	422.4	996.3
Jinja	555.0	527.4	1236.8
Pluggy	38.5	37.6	56.4
attrs	1067.1	1169.5	2833.9
ExceptionGroup	30.2	29.1	41.8

Packaging has 26,948 declared checks. One dense float64 affinity matrix alone would require about 5.81 GB (5.41 GiB); dictionary/heap clustering needs more. The compiler therefore records optimization UNKNOWN under its 2 GiB campaign budget, retains every ID and supplies an explicitly labeled compact fallback only for conformance/scaling records. It is excluded from the five-project compiler comparison rather than being counted as a tie.

7.5 Transfer to historical-source regressions

An additional frozen plan selects eleven real upstream fix commits by syntax and history, transplants their parent production modules into isolated release snapshots, and runs unchanged release tests with stop-on-first-failure. Nine cases execute; eight preserve the release registry. Two startup incompatibilities and one changed semantic ID set are VOID for paired analysis. One matching Packaging case remains UNKNOWN because fitting was not admitted. The seven measured transfers yield two primary wins, three ties and two losses. In particular, Click's primary layout costs 2.09% and 2.58% more than the historical compact layout on its two partial trajectories. The retained all-pass Jinja case is unrevealing, rather than excluded.

These are exploratory source transplants under a newer fixed test contract, not executions of each native historical parent suite or a certified natural-bug benchmark. They share project tests and supply no extra independent project replication. No source-transfer outcome changes the frozen layout. The losses demonstrate that training monotonicity and a successful repeated-snapshot holdout do not ensure benefit after a source or stopping-pattern change.

7.6 Whole-trajectory service accounting

The original comparison admits ten traces from five projects at the fixed 2,048-check service budget; both complete Packaging inputs remain UNKNOWN without subsampling. It executes four arms, three randomized-order repeats and cold/warm queries at initial, intermediate and final snapshots. All 5,040 service/oracle answer checks agree, including exact epoch and missing-check disclosure. Each arm delivers the same complete answer bytes under the common deterministic codec.

TABLE 6
Primary cap32 padded-byte reduction (%) under controlled dispatch shifts relative to historical compact selection. Ranges span the three fixed seeds; negative values are losses. No refitting.

Project	File groups	Individual items
Click	-4.85 to -3.33	-9.01 to -8.94
Jinja	0.15 to 0.17	-0.12 to -0.07
Pluggy	0.00	0.00
attrs	0.00	0.00
ExceptionGroup	0.00	0.00

These original timings include observational serialization for byte counters, including whole-state serialization at every ingest. They measure the instrumented prototype rather than isolated functional service costs. All 30 matched timing-repeat HACT32/counter ratios exceed one (range 1.216–2.850); repeated timings are descriptive, not independent project replications. The separately frozen observer ablation below measures the effect of this instrumentation.

The selected HACT service is slower than the maintained-counter ledger in every admitted project case. Its ratio of mean case-median operation times ranges from 1.44 to 2.42 on this host. Additional layout fitting and manifest admission cannot turn those observed service losses into a positive end-to-end speedup. The table times precompiled service execution and does not hide fitting inside common checker time. Compiler receipts retain separate one-time fit/selection measurements; their concurrent collection load makes them descriptive rather than controlled speedup estimates. The outcome supports a maintained ledger as the initial service baseline for these requests, while preserving the distinct within-format packet savings above.

7.7 Controlled dispatch-shift transfer

The new campaign contains 36 complete suite executions and 20,580 check executions. Six initial ExceptionGroup runs are VOID for cost analysis: the profiler observed an ignored build-generated version module absent from the frozen tracked-source inventory. Their raw records are retained. A separate child protocol freezes that module before rerunning all six predeclared schedules, without changing tests, seeds, layouts or endpoints. The resulting admitted comparison has 30 executions and 19,968 checks over five projects; it does not silently reclassify the original exclusions. All admitted runs retain the original registry and status counts, including attrs' environment-related failures.

Against the historical selected comparator, file-group shuffling gives three primary wins, nine ties and three losses; item shuffling gives zero wins, nine ties and six losses. The comparison unit here is a scheduled process, not an independent project. The small Jinja file-group gain survives, whereas Click loses under both shifts. The three ties are projects whose primary selection did not change. This directly limits the inference from the repeated-pattern holdout. Every seed, all four frozen layouts, the original compact comparison and secondary cap64 prices are retained in the artifact. Neither the intervention nor the analytical witness identifies natural deployment prevalence or a causal higher-order benefit.

TABLE 7
Observer ablation. Disabled columns are mean case-median operation times (ms); ratios compare HACT32 with counters in the same campaign. Inst.=original instrumentation; off=byte observers disabled.

	Observers off (ms)		HACT/counter	
Project	Counter	HACT32	Inst.	Off
Click	137.9	429.2	2.16	3.11
Jinja	140.3	446.1	2.23	3.18
Pluggy	23.0	37.1	1.45	1.61
attrs	261.3	924.9	2.64	3.54
ExceptionGroup	20.3	39.0	1.43	1.92

7.8 Service costs with byte observers disabled

The separate ablation completes 240 arm executions: ten held-out traces, three repeats and eight arms. All 10,080 raw-oracle/common-codec answer checks agree; the two complete Packaging traces remain UNKNOWN under the unchanged service budget. Table 7 compares the same primary layout to the maintained-counter ledger within each new timing block.

Removing observational serialization reduces absolute service time but does not reverse the comparison. Primary HACT is slower than counters in every paired timing block under both instrumentation states. With observers disabled, the project ratios of mean case medians range from 1.61 to 3.54; individual paired-block ratios range from 1.135 to 4.630. These are descriptive host-specific ranges, not confidence intervals. The disabled variant retains functional packet serialization, evidence digests, record copies, validation, caches and codec round trips. It is a controlled prototype ablation, not an optimized production implementation. The negative service result therefore survives the identified observer-cost confound for this demand.

7.9 Exact scoring interfaces and conditional adoption

Proposition 9 separates two requirements: retaining enough information to fit a new layout, and scoring a frozen catalogue. On all 90 three-block partitions of six checks, an exact rational calculation gives rank 16 for the constant and fifteen pairwise same-window features, rising to 17 after appending the grouped-versus-flat paired score. A single additional score feature suffices for this fixed comparison. The rank calculation verifies the scoring statement; the earlier global-optimum theorems supply the stronger optimization obstruction.

The independent literal-tree scorer agrees with the paired implementation and structural envelope in 247,680 comparisons: all 2,752 labeled unordered six-leaf trees against flat, across all 90 complete three-window partitions. The checks include arbitrary display orders; four-leaf regressions also enumerate every feasible width/window-count combination. These are exact analytical conformance checks, not new software projects.

For the complete-epoch witness at the implemented prices, the grouped layout saves an expected 32 bytes under P and loses 102.4 under Q. Its paired support interval is $[-3328, 256]$, of width 3,584 bytes; bounding both whole costs separately gives width 22,784. Their squared width ratio is approximately 40.41, a bound-dependent sample-complexity comparison, not measured task acceleration.

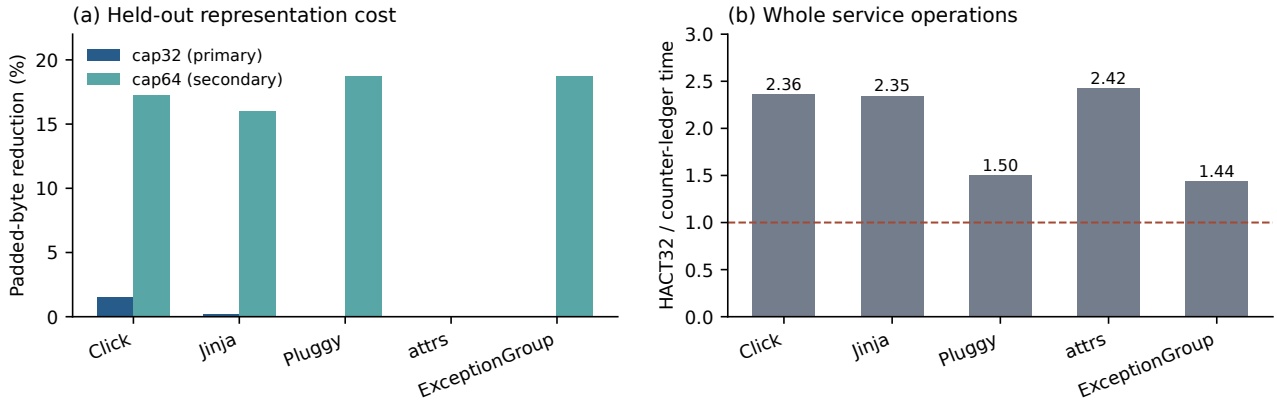


Fig. 2. Different endpoints lead to different adoption decisions. Left: primary and prespecified secondary held-out padded-byte savings. Right: original instrumented precompiled service time of primary HACT divided by the maintained-counter ledger; values above one are slower. Packaging is UNKNOWN under resource admission and is not plotted as zero.

TABLE 8
Synthetic conditional adoption counts. Repeated prefixes are dependent within seed. Under Q, neither bound adopts at any listed size.

Calibration m	P: paired	P: whole	Q: paired
100	0/20	0/20	0/20
1,000	0/20	0/20	0/20
10,000	1/20	0/20	0/20
100,000	20/20	0/20	0/20

TABLE 9
Exact symmetric-model baseline versus frozen full-wave cap32. Savings (%) retain both successful and unfavorable dispatch policies.

Project	Checks	Item shuffle	File groups
click	761	+15.67	-7.29
jinja	909	+7.22	-11.50
pluggy	124	+5.28	-15.77
attrs	1,432	+8.26	-23.77
exceptiongroup	102	+7.00	-10.60

We fix the two layouts, $\delta = 0.05$, zero shift, a 1,000-epoch horizon and 3,684 additional pre-horizon installation bytes before a seeded synthetic calibration study. Twenty seeds per law use nested prefixes of 100,000 draws. Table 8 reports conditional-adoption counts for Equation (15); whole-cost bounds use the same observed paired means and installation ledger. The direct streaming API agrees with the intended positive scenario and retains the incumbent when the declared TV radius rises to 0.01. No population significance or empirical confidence coverage is inferred from these twenty seeds.

Even with infinite calibration and no installation charge, a mean saving of 32 bytes cannot make this lower bound positive for $\rho \geq 32/3584 = 1/112$. This is the limit of this conservative certificate, not a sharp minimax drift tolerance or an estimate of software-workload drift. All five admitted public-project rows remain UNKNOWN: repeated snapshots and controlled schedule interventions supply neither the required independent natural calibration nor an externally justified deployment TV bound. Packaging's resource exclusion is retained separately. This new analysis neither changes the historical 3/18/9 shift outcomes nor establishes a service advantage over the maintained-counter ledger.

7.10 A stronger symmetric-model baseline

The exact size-state solver matches independent all-tree enumeration in 70 combinations of size, fanout and flush width, totaling 74,245 feasible tree comparisons for $n \leq 6$. Its reference averages actual completion permutations rather than importing the hypergeometric formula. Additional regressions cover every small positive batch-size composition, arbitrary leaf orders, three packet-price regimes and exact reconstruction. This checks the model-specific global optimum, not the symmetry of software data.

We then fit this baseline to registry size and the declared eight-record flush only, using canonical semantic order and no training traces. This retrospective comparison re-encodes the same 25 original executions and 30 admitted dispatch interventions; it adds no checker execution. The baseline beats the frozen cap32 full-wave layout on all 15 item-shuffled traces and loses on all 15 file-group traces. Table 9 uses per-project ratios of summed bytes across three retained seeds per policy. Positive values mean fewer padded bytes than the frozen full-wave layout. Policy/seed repetitions are not independent projects.

On the original repeated-order holdouts, the model baseline instead costs 21.26–62.13% more than frozen full-wave selection. Packaging remains outside the 2,048-check fitting budget. These outcomes identify complementary regimes: size-only topology is a strong control for dispersed completions, while learned locality can matter for structured groups. Shuffled dispatch does not prove exchangeable completion times. The baseline's smaller packet cost in one controlled regime does not overturn the counter-ledger service result or establish a net lifecycle benefit on natural consumer demand.

8 Related Work

Test prioritization, regression selection and self-adjusting computation already optimize which work is executed and recomputed [8], [9], [10], [11]. HACT leaves the approved registry and check schedule under the runner's control; its local pass requires the entire declared contract. It does not reproduce regression selection systems or assert superiority over them.

Graham, Li and Yao price every touched ancestor in batch-update key trees and derive structural bounds and an $O(n)$ solver for their independent Bernoulli replacement model [18]. Thus touched-ancestor pricing and cardinality-based tree DP precede HACT. Our fixed-size without-replacement batches, affine capped packets and cold-build charge define the exact baseline in Section 5.3; the information separation concerns correlated laws outside that symmetric regime. Alphabetic-tree optimization supplies the fixed-order dynamic program [6]. Pairwise seriation supplies an established ordering proposal [12]. Dasgupta's objective charges pairwise similarities through hierarchical cluster sizes [13]; constrained hierarchical clustering explicitly uses three-hypergraph objectives [14]. Balanced and hierarchical hypergraph partitioning likewise prices collective communication [15]. HACT's affine arity prices, every-touched-node objective, unrestricted shapes and lifecycle costs differ from these models. Their hardness or approximation guarantees do not transfer automatically.

Authenticated workload-adaptive structures optimize access and proof costs [16]. HACT's local binding capsules are not membership proofs, signatures or attestations. Verification-first AI engineering and trace-assurance frameworks govern actions and checks [4], [5]; HACT isolates the representation that accumulates after such checks. Its optional migration policies specialize established switching-cost expert methods; the full historical manuscript retains their assumptions and negative comparisons. Batched telemetry and ordinary compression remain required controls, not techniques displaced by a tree. Independent calibration followed by simultaneous risk testing is an established framework [17]. Our adoption rule specializes this principle to differences of verification-packet costs, with semantic coverage cancellation, declared completion support and separately priced installation. Its Hoeffding and total-variation arguments are standard.

9 Threats to Validity and Deployment Guidance

The packet objective is additive and format-specific. Byte constants, refresh batching and fixed execution schedules constrain external validity. The theorem establishes a worst-case information limit, not that most workloads need higher moments. The new refinement is exact only in its declared restricted class and to the reference DP's numerical precision. A different proposal budget or order can produce different results. The conditional adoption rule does not repair unknown sampling or drift. The archived software cohorts do not establish its IID calibration and deployment-radius assumptions. Its synthetic validation demonstrates conformance within a specified model; it adds no independent software cases. The exchangeable optimum is exact for its law, not for arbitrary completion traces. Canonical labels, rather than learned locality, define its empirical baseline. Its item/file reversal and original-holdout losses preclude universal superiority. The retrospective baseline comparison is descriptive; dispatch intervention is not a test establishing exchangeability.

The convenience sample has six small Python projects, one excluded from fitting. The five admitted projects repeat completion patterns across original splits, establishing repeatability. Dispatch interventions probe artificial schedule changes; neither cohort establishes natural workflow generalization. Packaging supplies 89.0% of the initial executions; the admitted compiler cohort has 25 runs and 16,640 checks. Historical replays, normal-suite repeats and transplanted regressions remain distinct sampling units. Environment incompatibilities remain recorded and are not automatically attributed to upstream defects.

Controlled fixed-group demand favors maintained counters. A useful tree region requires independently justified delivery or aggregation savings that repay lifecycle costs. Equal codec bytes establish conformance. No live-model, token-billing or physical-WAN benefit is inferred from these local measurements.

The safety result assumes trusted immutable checking and atomic local fencing. Tests do not certify test adequacy, and a report file is not an atomic external commit. The mathematical conclusions are conditional on the stated model and information interface, and empirical conclusions are limited to the recorded cohort and demand. These limits determine the contribution's external validity.

10 Conclusion

Joint completion events contain optimization information that exact pairwise summaries can irretrievably lose. Under exchangeability, however, cardinality alone suffices for a global optimum without learning. Adaptive HACT separates these regimes while keeping adaptive representations outside semantic authority. Its exact symmetric baseline and bounded full-wave refiner expose complementary strengths on dispersed and grouped completions; the evaluation preserves the unfavorable cases and strong ledger controls. The adoption rule quantifies when independent paired evidence can cover sampling uncertainty, a declared shift allowance and installation bytes. The practical implication is conditional: keep semantic authority fixed, retain full completion sets when fitting the stated packet objective, and validate under the changes expected in deployment. The controlled dispatch losses reject universal transfer, and the observer-disabled service comparison supports maintained counters for the evaluated requests. Retain the incumbent when independent lifecycle evidence does not justify a change.

Data and Code Availability

The accompanying v14 artifact contains code, versioned observations, exact references and independent audits. Historical releases are available at https://github.com/xuda1979/future-code/tree/main/hact-paper/Adaptive_HACT_v5. The release manifest binds source and PDF bytes; it is not a signature. The artifact includes the full historical analysis,

raw execution receipts, a reproduction guide and a claim-to-evidence map. A hash-bound offline archive restores the original observation paths before manifest verification and independent audits; it preserves every recorded exclusion and outcome.

Declaration of Generative AI Assistance

OpenAI Codex assisted with text, proofs, code, experiment execution and automated independent checks throughout this revision. Those checks are not human peer review. The authors are responsible for the final content and will review it before any submission.

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